simultaneously factor in the great sympathy for the Tibetans in India.[72] But there was concern that, without any sign of American support to the Tibetans, the Dalai Lama would acquiesce to a cautious India's demands and consequently lose his symbolic influence. Thus Dillon recommended a UN appeal, assuring the Dalai Lama of American financial support, and finding an alternate asylum destination if necessary.[73] Eisenhower, however, did not want the Dalai Lama to break with Nehru. Moreover, he indicated only limited American support.[74] And American attempts to find another home for the Dalai Lama were unsuccessful.[75]

Overall, Washington did not want to take any action that would jeopardize the Tibetan leader's presence in India. The US decided to tell the Dalai Lama to defer the recognition question. It would, however, help the Tibetans submit their appeal to the UN, while ensuring that Delhi was kept in the loop.[76]

Indian officials had considered and dismissed the idea of taking the Tibet issue up at the UN.[77] They told their American interlocutors that one reason was to avoid making Tibet a Cold War issue—if it became one, Moscow, which had remained silent, would be forced to take Beijing's side. Moreover, the Indian foreign secretary pointed out that an appeal would not result in any real action because "no one is going to war with China over Tibet." Furthermore, it would be ineffective because Beijing was not even represented at the UN. Finally, it would only intensify the Chinese crackdown. Dutt acknowledged that the sentiment in India favoring a UN appeal meant that the Indian government would not oppose an appeal that was phrased appropriately. Overall, India's policy would be "firm" toward China, but careful since "we have to be friends with [a] powerful country with whom we have [a] border of 2,680 miles."[78] The US, attuned to the Indian government's sensitivities, subsequently urged the Dalai Lama to focus on the charge of human rights violations rather than aggression in any appeal, and to keep Indian officials updated.[79]

In September 1959, Eisenhower conveyed his "distress" and "concern" to Nehru about Chinese actions at the border and in Tibet. He stated that countries should not "abandon negotiation and conciliation in favor of force and strife," and yet once again Beijing was "disregard[ing] … that principle."[80] The president was kept updated on the situation. At an NSC meeting, Allen Dulles outlined the intelligence assessment that Delhi would